

YEN Cuisine Japonaise

AI phone assistant — progress report and cost breakdown
Prepared 29 July 2026

Summary

The assistant answers the phone in French, understands English, and books real tables directly in your Libro account. It has been tested end to end and books correctly.

Running it costs roughly **\$15 CAD per month**, against the **\$275 CAD per month** currently being paid to the existing provider — a saving of about **\$3,100 CAD per year**.

	Today	Proposed
Monthly running cost	~\$275 CAD	~ \$15 CAD
Calls that reach a booking	15%	to be measured
Calls handed to a human	43%	to be measured
Takeout callers helped	none	captured for callback
Cancellations by phone	not possible	handled automatically
Who owns the call data	the provider	you do

The 15% and 43% figures are measured from 84 real calls to your line between 30 June and 25 July 2026, taken from the current provider's own records.

What is built and working

Capability	Status
Answers in French, switches to English if the caller does	Working
Checks live availability in Libro	Working
Creates, changes and cancels real reservations	Working — verified on a live booking
Reads the phone number back before booking; understands “demain soir”, “sept heures”, “vendredi prochain”	Working
Offers alternatives when the requested time is full	Working
Takes takeout requests for a callback	Working
Answers hours, address, parking and dietary questions; refuses to quote prices or discuss complaints	Working
Passes groups of 7+ to a person (Libro cannot hold those tables)	Working
Dashboard showing every call, outcome and transcript	Working
Answering a real phone number	Next step — needs the accounts below
Live transfer to a staff member	Needs a decision — see page 3

Costs

All amounts in Canadian dollars. Converted from USD at 1.37, which should be confirmed against the rate on the day of payment.

Built on your own accounts throughout. Nothing is locked to a vendor: the logic, the wording it uses and every call record belong to the restaurant, and the system can be moved or handed to another developer without rebuilding it.

One-time — development

Item	Detail	Cost
AI development tooling	Claude Max subscription, one month, used to build the system	\$137
Development time	To be agreed separately	—
One-time total		\$137

This is a cost already incurred to build the system, not an ongoing charge. It does not repeat.

Recurring — monthly running cost

Service	What it does	Monthly
Server hosting	Runs the assistant, always on, in Toronto	\$8.00
Phone number	A Montreal 514 number, plus per-minute charges	\$2.30
Speech recognition	Understanding the caller, French and English	\$1.20
Voice	The French voice the caller hears	\$1.80
Language model	Understanding what the caller wants	\$1.50
Call records database	Stored in Canada; free at this volume	\$0.00
Call handling	Connects the phone line; free at this volume	\$0.00
Recurring total		~\$15 / month

Based on your measured call volume: 102 calls and 111 minutes of conversation per month. Most of this total is fixed — the server and the phone number are about two thirds of it — so the cost changes very little if calls increase. Roughly double the call volume before it moves noticeably.

Comparison

	Per month	Per year
Current provider	~\$275	~\$3,300
Proposed	~\$15	~\$180
Saving	~\$260	~\$3,120

Every account is opened in the restaurant's name, and each provider bills you directly. There is no markup on any of the figures above.

What happens next

Two things are needed from you, and one decision.

1. Accounts to open

Each of these is opened in the restaurant's name so you own it outright. Setup takes about half a day in total, and none of them need attention afterwards.

Account	Why	Card needed
Hosting (Fly.io)	Runs the assistant	Yes
Phone (Twilio)	The new 514 number	Yes
Google AI	Understanding callers	Yes — free tier is not reliable enough for a live line
Deepgram	Speech recognition and voice	Already open
LiveKit	Connects the phone line	Already open
Supabase	Call records, stored in Canada	No

2. A new phone number, not your existing one

The assistant answers a brand-new 514 number. Your existing line, 514-543-3354, is untouched and rings in the restaurant exactly as it does today. Nothing changes for your current callers until you decide to point them at it.

3. One decision we need from you

When the assistant cannot help, what should happen?

You asked for the call to be transferred to a person. That is straightforward to build — but you also mentioned that during a rush the phone often goes unanswered, and a rush is exactly when the assistant will be transferring. A transfer into an unanswered phone is worse for the caller than what happens today.

Our suggestion: **transfer first, and if nobody picks up within a few rings, take the caller's name and number so you can call them back.** You get the live transfer you asked for, and nobody is lost when the room is busy. Happy to build it either way — it is your call.

Timeline

Stage	What it involves
Now	Testing the conversation in every scenario
Next	Open the accounts above; connect the phone number
Then	You and I call the test number and listen to it work
Go live	Point calls at it — starting with overflow only, so it answers only when nobody else can

A note on the figures: the running costs are provider list prices applied to your measured call volume. Nothing here has been on a real invoice yet, so the first month should be treated as the number to confirm. The \$275 comparison figure is taken from your current provider's invoice.